

What's more, Automator is dumbed down, so it's not restricted to the geeks. It automatically detects if original files are being overwritten and offers to insert a copy command. It narrows down actions by means of relevance, for instance, it will not show the "Burn to DVD" action as relevant if the current step is "Compose New Mail". Automator also marks as action in a workflow red if it finds that the actions are not compatible with each other.



Use the integrated Spotlight search to narrow down your options

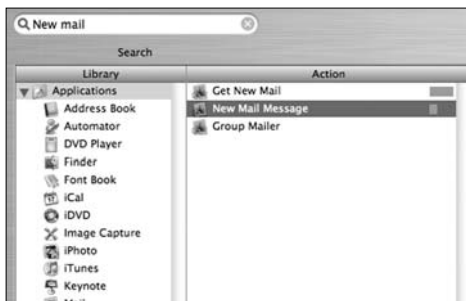
5.7.1 Automator Explained

Creating a workflow in Automator, as mentioned before, is easy as drag and drop. Just drag actions from the Action pane to the workflow area to create a seamless workflow. Actions can be narrowed down by the integrated Spotlight search or clicking on an application group from the Library window.

To explain this better, let's make a workflow that will copy all documents edited within the week, compress to an archive, and e-mail them to a specified address.

Step 1:

First, we need to keep an open e-mail ready with all the details. Simply typing new mail in the search bar narrows it down to the "New Mail Message" action. There is a relevance bar that acts as a guide to what action to choose.



Get to the "New Mail" action